

Alberta Tourism Market Monitor

More domestic flights added at Edmonton International Airport

Calgary-based airline WestJet announced on July 27th 2015 that regional services to and from Edmonton International Airport will be expanded. The expansion will include more than 60 flights per week to Kelowna, Regina, Saskatoon, Grande Prairie and Calgary. In addition, a new non-stop daily flight between Nanaimo and Edmonton will take off for the first time on December 15.

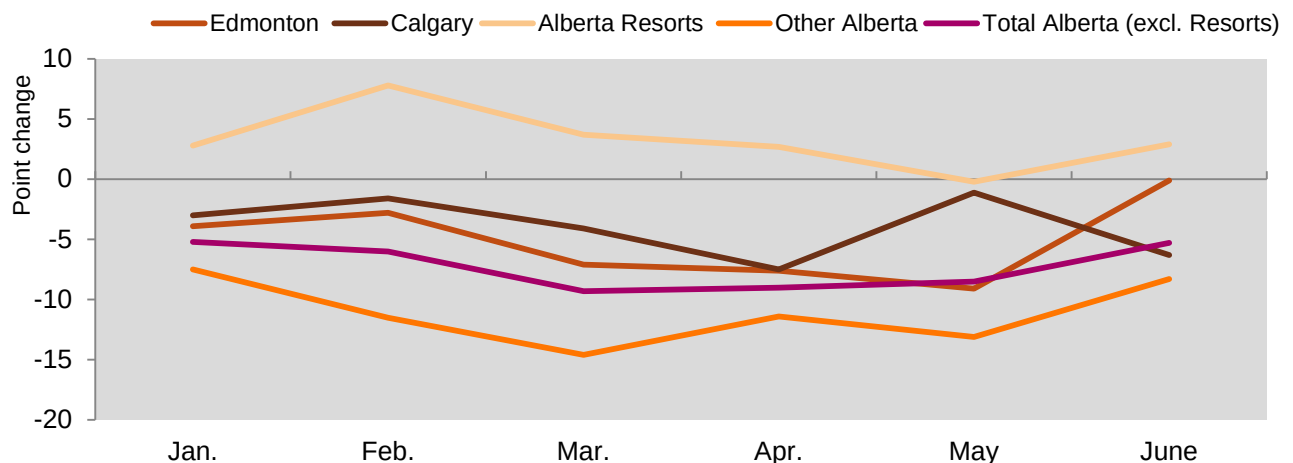
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Accommodation indices reflect weak economic activity

Accommodation indices for most of Alberta, excluding Alberta Resorts, continued to weaken for the sixth consecutive month (January – June 2015). The occupancy rate for Total Alberta (excluding Resorts) was 65.3% in June 2015, representing a decrease of 5.3 points from last June. Other Alberta (including Lethbridge, Red Deer, and other Alberta Communities) had the largest decline in its occupancy rate, with an 8.3 percentage point decrease in June 2015, compared to the same month in 2014, followed by Calgary (70.2%), with a decrease of 6.3 percentage points in the same month. In contrast, the Alberta Resorts occupancy rate (78.7% for June) saw moderate growth of 2.9 percentage points, compared to June 2014.

As oil price woes linger, business related travel within the province seems to have been cut back significantly, a process that will likely continue for the foreseeable future. The Alberta Resorts accommodation indices, however, remain strong, which is reflective of a resilient leisure market. This could possibly be attributed to the weaker Canadian dollar (against major currencies such as the US dollar and Euro), which makes Canada more attractive as an international travel destination.

**Percentage Point Changes in Alberta Occupancy Rates - 2015
(year-over-year comparison)**



2015 Alberta Tourism Market Monitor
Alberta Culture and Tourism

	Jan.	Feb.	Mar.	Apr.	May	June	July	August	Sept.	Oct.	Nov.	Dec.	Yr-to-Date
Air Passengers 2015 (000's of arrivals and departures) ¹													
Edmonton International Total	582.1p	561.6p	613.8p	592.7p	565.5p	598.8r	680.5p						4,194.9p
Per cent change from 2014	-0.3%	-1.0%	-1.8%	-4.4%	-5.4%	0.9%	2.0%						-1.4%
Domestic	398.2p	380.9p	421.4p	413.4p	438.7p	490.9r	559.6p						3,103.1p
Per cent change from 2014	-2.7%	-2.9%	-1.3%	-5.9%	-4.6%	2.7%	4.4%						-1.2%
Transborder	118.2p	119.7p	129.1p	119.3p	95.1p	82.5p	90.4p						754.3p
Per cent change from 2014	-0.3%	-3.0%	-7.8%	-9.0%	-12.9%	-10.2%	-13.1%						-7.7%
International	65.7p	61.0p	63.2p	60.1p	31.6p	25.4p	30.6p						337.5p
Per cent change from 2014	16.8%	17.9%	9.8%	21.8%	10.5%	9.0%	14.3%						15.0%
Calgary International Total	1,199.0p	1,149.3r	1,267.0r	1225.7p	1,257.1p	1,299.7p							7,398.1p
Per cent change from 2014	2.3%	-0.4%	1.5%	-2.3%	2.6%	2.8%							1.1%
Domestic	800.6p	765.0p	839.7r	844.4p	909.8r	949.2p							5,109.3p
Per cent change from 2014	1.1%	-0.9%	2.3%	-2.9%	4.8%	3.7%							1.4%
Transborder	254.6p	253.4p	280.9p	252.1p	237.5r	243.5p							1,522.1p
Per cent change from 2014	1.8%	-3.0%	-3.7%	-6.3%	-4.6%	2.9%							-2.3%
International	143.8p	130.8p	146.5p	129.2p	109.7p	106.9p							766.8p
Per cent change from 2014	9.9%	8.0%	8.0%	10.6%	1.1%	-5.2%							5.7%
Highway Count 2015 (000's of vehicles) ²													
Hwy 1 -Sask border w-bound	57.7	57.3	64.7	72.8	80.1								332.6
Per cent change from 2014	3.2%	2.3%	3.9%	1.8%	3.6%								3.0%
Hwy 1 - Banff Pk Gate (2-way)	501.8	505.5	544.6	568.2	679.2								2799.3
Per cent change from 2014	6.1%	12.6%	9.1%	6.7%	15.9%								10.2%
Hwy 16 - Jasper Pk Gate (2 way)	96.3	92.8	111.7	123.4	149.2								573.4
Per cent change from 2014	4.9%	9.6%	6.2%	-1.0%	7.0%								5.1%
Hwy 16 - Blackfoot w-bound	164.1	146.6	170.8	177.8	186.6								845.9
Per cent change from 2014	-3.2%	-7.0%	-6.5%	-5.2%	-7.0%								-5.8%
National Park Attendance (000's of person visits) 2015 ³ Does not include Group Tours													
Banff	184.9p	188.6p	203.8p	246.7p	296.4p								1,120.4p
Per cent change from 2014	8.1%	14.6%	10.7%	6.7%	14.8%								11.0%
Jasper	52.8p	53.6p	64.1p	147.1p	178.1p								495.7p
Per cent change from 2014	6.0%	11.1%	7.4%	3.5%	10.3%								7.4%
Waterton Lakes	6.7p	7.5p	9.3p	14.8p	39.2p	73.5p	114.3p						265.3p
Per cent change from 2014	3.5%	19.1%	47.6%	34.5%	26.9%	22.9%	11.5%						18.8%
Employment (000's of persons) 2015 Seasonally Adjusted ⁴													
Accommodation and Food Services	156.9p	157.6p	155.9p	152.8p	157.1p	157.7p	154.4p						156.1p
Per cent change from 2014	4.4%	1.5%	3.7%	0.9%	5.3%	9.2%	9.1%						4.7%
Sources: Edmonton International Airport, Calgary International Airport, Alberta Transportation, Parks Canada, Statistics Canada.													

	Jan.	Feb.	Mar.	Apr.	May	June	July	August	Sept.	Oct.	Nov.	Dec.	Yr-to-Date
Accommodation Indices 2015 ⁵													
Edmonton Occupancy Rate	54.4%	65.3%	67.1%	67.7%	64.3%	69.7%							65.0%
Point change from 2014	-3.9	-2.8	-7.1	-7.6	-9.1	-0.1							-5.1
Average Daily Room Rate	\$131.29	\$134.52	\$135.93	\$134.91	\$133.27	\$138.75							\$137.24
Variance from 2014	1.4%	1.0%	0.5%	0.2%	-0.8%	1.3%							0.0%
Revenue per available room	\$71.42	\$87.81	\$91.22	\$91.40	\$85.73	\$96.77							\$89.26
Calgary Occupancy Rate	55.0%	61.8%	63.5%	64.1%	69.8%	70.2%							64.3%
Point change from 2014	-3.0	-1.6	-4.1	-7.5	-1.1	-6.3							-3.8
Average Daily Room Rate	\$156.48	\$156.30	\$156.76	\$159.31	\$159.78	\$171.43							\$160.32
Variance from 2014	-0.4%	-3.3%	-2.0%	-2.8%	-2.2%	-7.1%							-3.3%
Revenue per available room	\$86.08	\$96.56	\$99.56	\$102.11	\$111.55	\$120.33							\$103.04
Alberta Resorts Occupancy Rate	40.8%	53.3%	48.8%	48.9%	60.6%	78.7%							55.2%
Point change from 2014	2.8	7.8	3.7	2.7	-0.2	2.9							3.2
Average Daily Room Rate	\$183.23	\$177.86	\$176.03	\$170.91	\$201.13	\$260.92							\$201.39
Variance from 2014	10.5%	1.3%	5.4%	4.8%	6.8%	8.2%							6.1%
Revenue per available room	\$74.83	\$94.88	\$85.94	\$83.51	\$121.88	\$205.47							\$111.08
Other Alberta* Occupancy Rate	52.5%	55.0%	53.3%	48.3%	51.3%	58.6%							53.3%
Point change from 2014	-7.5	-11.5	-14.6	-11.4	-13.1	-8.3							-10.9
Average Daily Room Rate	\$133.36	\$132.26	\$131.29	\$128.86	\$126.21	\$127.84							\$130.14
Variance from 2014	2.7%	1.1%	0.3%	-0.7%	-2.2%	-1.9%							0.0%
Revenue per available room	\$69.96	\$72.74	\$70.01	\$62.20	\$64.77	\$74.90							\$69.34
Total Alberta (excl. Resorts) Occupancy Rate	53.8%	60.0%	60.2%	58.6%	60.4%	65.3%							60.0%
Point change from 2014	-5.2	-6	-9.3	-9.0	-8.5	-5.3							-7.1
Average Daily Room Rate	\$139.70	\$140.35	\$140.75	\$141.06	\$139.71	\$145.07							\$141.92
Variance from 2014	1.4%	0.0%	0.1%	-0.9%	-1.2%	-3.1%							-0.8%
Revenue per available room	\$75.12	\$84.22	\$84.76	\$82.69	\$84.39	\$94.68							\$85.11
Food Services and Drinking Places 2015 (\$ Millions) unadjusted ⁶													
Total Receipts for Alberta	\$689.4r	\$658.1r	\$729.7r	\$723.2r	\$768.6p								\$713.8p
Per cent change from 2014	6.0%	4.4%	1.6%	2.1%	2.0%								3.1%
Historic Sites and Museums 2015 (000's of person visits) ⁷													
Visitor Attendance	24.3p	42.4r	48.6p	48.5p	80.2p	113.0p	181.4p						538.4p
Per cent change from 2014	3.4%	6.5%	26.2%	2.1%	3.5%	-2.2%	13.0%						7.1%
Exchange Rates 2015 ⁸													
Canadian Dollar/U.S. Dollar (noon)	0.81	0.80	0.79	0.81	0.82	0.81	0.76						0.80
Canadian Dollar/ Euro	0.71	0.71	0.73	0.75	0.74	0.82	0.69						0.74
Canadian Dollar/ Great British Pounds	0.53	0.52	0.53	0.54	0.53	0.52	0.49						0.52
Oil Price: Western Texas Intermediate (WTI) 2015⁹													
Cushing, OK Spot Price (US Dollar per Barrel)	47.22	50.58	47.82	54.45	59.27	59.82	50.9						52.87
Sources: PKF Consulting Inc, Statistics Canada, Alberta Culture, Bank of Canada, WTI													

*Other Alberta includes Lethbridge, Red Deer, and other Alberta communities

Note : New monthly figures are shown in bold type. Revisions will be bolded.
r=revised p=preliminary

Definitions of Indicators

1. Air Passengers - Numbers are preliminary estimates of air passenger arrivals and departures at the Edmonton International and Calgary International Airports.

Source: Edmonton International Airport and Calgary International Airport Websites.

2. Highway Traffic: These data are monthly totals. The monthly average daily traffic (average number of vehicles per day) is calculated by dividing the monthly total by the number of days in the month passing the counter locations and in the direction indicated for a particular month. Automatic Traffic Recorders counts all vehicles by direction. Year-to-date is a cumulative total for all vehicles.

Source: Alberta Transportation's Automatic Traffic Recorders (ATR). <http://www.transportation.alberta.ca/3459.htm>

3. National Park Attendance - Attendance is reported as the number of visits to National Parks in Alberta. Data are preliminary unless otherwise noted.

Banff National Park and Jasper National Park reflect independent travellers only, and do not include people travelling as part of a tour group. The tour group data, however, are included in the annual edition of the Monthly Market Monitor.

Source: Parks Canada.

4. Employment Food and Accommodation Sector - The employment figure represents all persons who worked for pay or profit or unpaid work in the food services and accommodation sector, including businesses or other ventures owned or operated by a related family member(s) during the reference period of the survey. The year-to-date total is an average for the year.

Source: Statistics Canada, Labour Force Survey.

5. Accommodation Indices - Occupancy rates and average daily room rates are based on monthly averages of all reporting hotels, motels and motor hotels in each designated region. Alberta Resorts includes the resort communities of Banff, Lake Louise, Kananaskis, Canmore and Jasper.

Other Alberta includes Lethbridge, Red Deer, and other Alberta communities.

Revenue per available room is calculated using the occupancy rate and average daily room rate.

Source: PKF Consulting Inc. with reproduction and use of information subject to PKF Disclaimer and Restrictions as detailed at www.pkfcanada.com.

6. Food Services and Drinking Places - The monthly survey of Food Services and Drinking Places provides estimates of the value of sales and the number of locations of restaurants, caterers, and drinking places by province and by industry at the North American Industry Classification System (NAICS) four-digit level. Includes total receipts from restaurants, caterers and taverns for chain and independent establishments. The target population is the 3 digit NAICS level of 722, which includes: Full-service restaurants, limited service eating places, special food places and drinking places. The year-to-date total is an average for the year.

Source: Statistics Canada, Food Services and Drinking Places.

7. Historic Sites and Museums - Visitor attendance figures are monthly totals based on fifteen historic sites, the Royal Alberta Museum, the Royal Tyrrell Museum of Paleontology, and the Tyrrell Field Station.

Source: Alberta Culture

8. Exchange Rate- this is the average monthly exchange rate.

Source: Bank of Canada.

9. Western Texas Intermediate - This is the average monthly oil price.

Source: Cushing, OK WTI Spot Price FOB.

21-Aug-2015